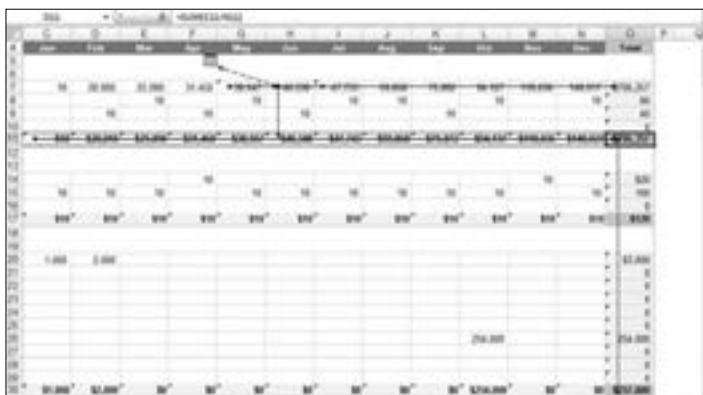


down to the “Display Options for this workbook” section, under the “For object, show” section, ensure that All (or Placeholders) is selected. If you have any external references to other workbooks, open those as well.

Next, select the cell whose formula you want to trace. In the Formulas tab, click on Trace Precedents and/or Trace Dependents as required. Blue arrows will show the references to and from the cell if there are no errors. If there are errors, a red arrow will be shown. If the data is in another worksheet, a worksheet icon will be shown.



**Precedents and Dependents**

You can click on the Trace Precedents and Dependents button again and again to trace the formulas to multiple levels. To remove all tracer arrows, click Remove arrows. Once all the levels have been traced, Excel will inform you that there are no more levels to trace. You can double-click on the black arrow which points to an external reference and in the resulting Go To pop-up window, select the sheet where the reference is.

Tracing the cell reference in this way will help you to visualise where all the data is coming from, and analyse for logical errors and inconsistencies.